Nikita Kliuchnikov

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Education

University of Zurich — Zürich, Switzerland
MA Finance, with Minor in Data Science — *Sep 2026 – Expected Jun 2028*
Current coursework: Empirical Methods | Asset Management | Backtesting for Portfolio Management.

ETH Zurich — Zürich, Switzerland
Elective coursework at MSc Quantitative Finance — *Sep 2026 – Expected Jun 2028*
Current coursework: Mathematical Foundations for Finance | Probabilistic AI | Numerical Methods for CSE.

Higher School of Economics — Moscow, Russia
MSc Artificial Intelligence (online, part-time) — *Sep 2026 – Expected Jun 2028*

Higher School of Economics & New Economic School — Moscow, Russia
BA, Joint HSE-NES Undergraduate Program in Economics — *Sep 2022 – Jun 2026*
GPA: 9.24/10.00 (rank 3/70). **Selected coursework:** Stochastic Processes | Econometrics | Time Series Econometrics | Machine Learning 1 & 2 | Machine Learning in Finance | Financial Engineering | Empirical Finance.

Research

Can Market Microstructure Metrics Enhance Rug Pull Detection? (Bachelor Thesis) | *GitHub*
- Analyzed 32,426 token launches on Solana's Raydium DEX: found statistically significant gains in early rug-pull detection from eight market-microstructure features, including Kyle's lambda, Amihud illiquidity, and VPIN.
- Evaluated incremental model performance using DeLong tests and paired bootstrap; validated results across model architectures, labeling strategies, performance metrics, significance tests, and data design approaches; interpreted the improvement via TreeSHAP, comparing results to theoretical predictions.
- Introduced an approach to reproduce TAQ-like time series for tokens from large raw transactional data. Constructed an SQL-based data collection pipeline and a feature-design pipeline via Pandas and Polars.

Mean Anchoring: Reproducing Generalized Mean Generators | *Website*
- Derived the class of all continuous functions that produce a pre-selected de Finetti-Kolmogorov-Nagumo generalized mean, given an arbitrary random variable; implemented the transformation in Python.

Experience

Higher School of Economics — Moscow, Russia
Teaching Assistant, Corporate Finance — *Sep 2025 – Dec 2025, Part-time*
- Graded assignments and examinations, maintained course records, and designed standardized rubrics and sample solutions to provide individualized feedback.

Yandex Fintech — Moscow, Russia
Data Analyst Intern — *Jun 2025 – Sep 2025, Full-time*
- Independently built an ML experimentation pipeline for credit-risk model R&D from scratch and ran robust offline evaluation on large-scale data, informing the development of a new credit-scoring model.
- Restored and adapted a legacy model-training pipeline for updated data and evaluation workflows.
- Developed a dashboard for automated performance monitoring of credit-scoring models.

Skills

Programming Languages: Python | SQL | C++ | R

ML Stack: NumPy | SciPy | Pandas | Polars | scikit-learn | CatBoost | PyTorch | Optuna | SHAP | Statsmodels

Tools: Git | LaTeX | PostgreSQL

Languages: Russian (native) | English (C2)

Awards & Achievements

New Economic School Olympiad in Mathematics and English, 2026: Prizewinner

Liubimov's International Mobility Scholarship, 2024: Recipient

United Interuniversity Mathematical Olympiad (OMMO), 2022: Prizewinner

All-Russian Olympiad, Regional Stage, 2022: Winner (Mathematics), Prizewinner (Economics)